

Forgotten frontline: Lessons from homelessness workers

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FRONTLINE WORKER SURVEY 2022



December early findings

Our sixth annual UK-wide survey of frontline workers supporting people experiencing homelessness

St Martin in the Fields Frontline Network

St Martin in the Fields Charity

St Martin in the Fields Frontline Network

Annual Frontline Worker Survey 2024

Executive Summary

The 7th annual UK-wide survey of frontline workers supporting people experiencing homelessness.



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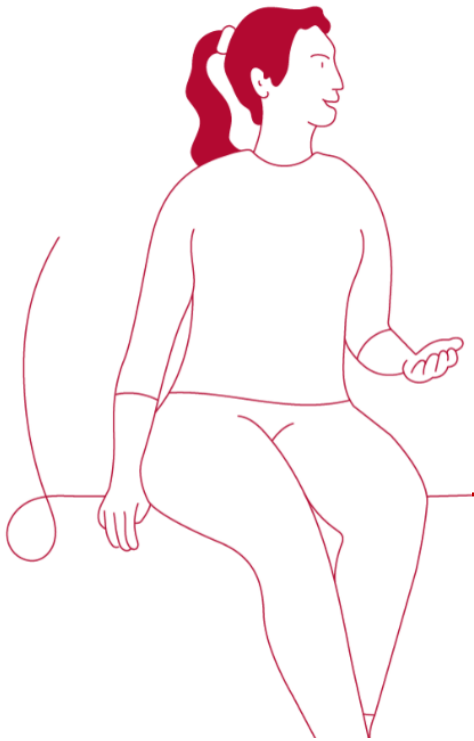
St Martin-in-the-Fields Charity
frontlinenetwork.org.uk
Smitfc.org.uk

@SMITFCharity
@SMITF_frontline


2
CAUTION
DECK
SLIPPERY
WHEN WET



“As there is limited social housing it has become increasingly difficult to find suitable accommodation for people. More people are getting placed in houses of multiple occupancy. These are not allowing people to move on from homelessness as they can be chaotic.”

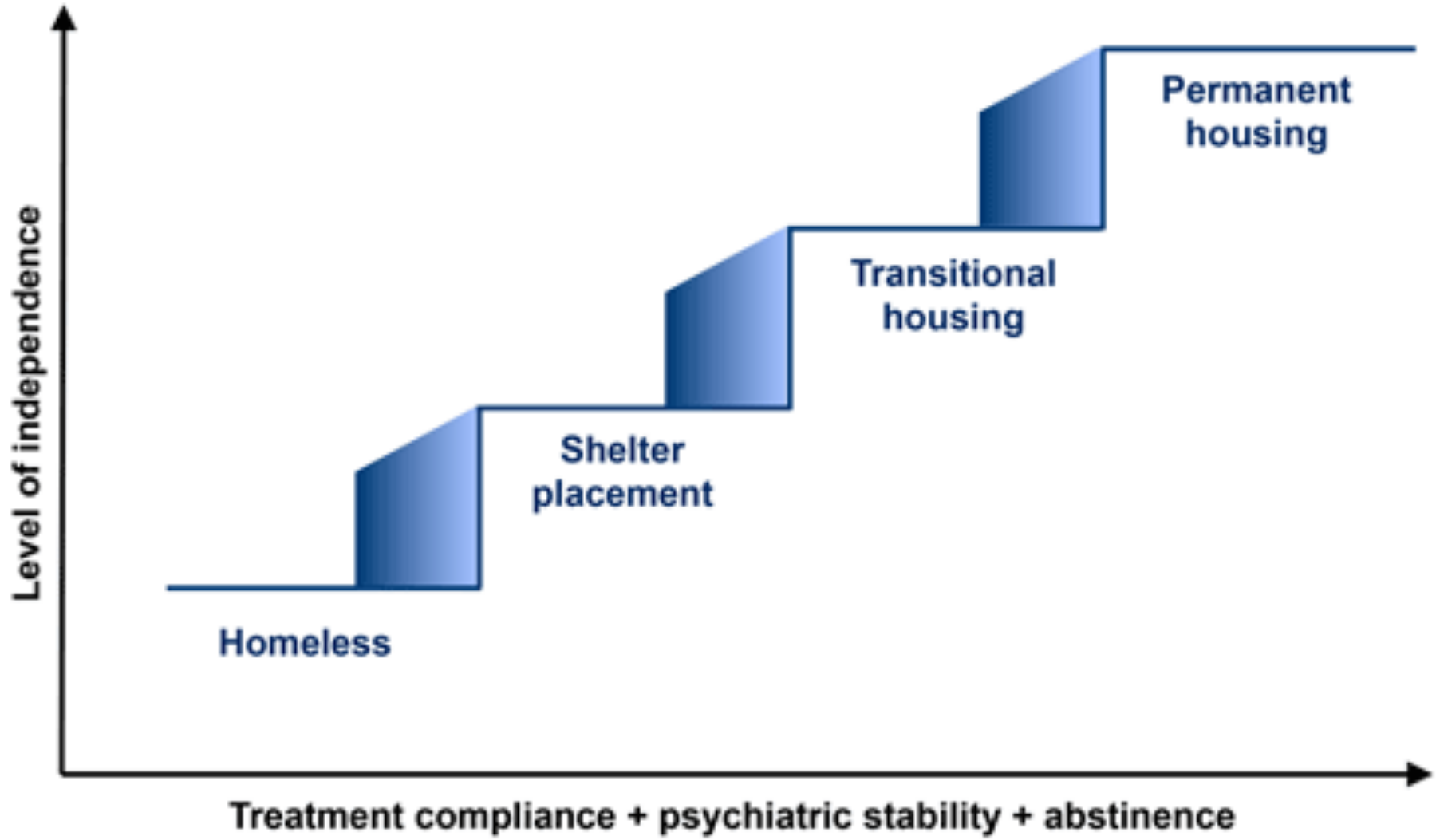




Big Issue 2020


Travelodge

Traditional system approach



“There is a large part of the demographic occupying hostels which is stuck. The result is that people can spend decades in supported accommodation hostels. People become institutionalised and traumatised - their problems are deepened by hostels rather than resolved.”




SUPPER
GROW
Wild
Is my gold necklace worth much?



“We see a lot of people with complex needs getting bounced between different services who all feel they don't have enough expertise in one area or other.”





“I can't stay in this sector, the system doesn’t help people and we reinforce that not by choice. The amount of times I have to say to a client that I’m sorry I can't help is a disgrace.”



“It is a constant conflict between experiencing vicarious trauma and remembering you are there to help. It is humbling but also can be crushing. It's a bit of a rollercoaster.”



Ministry of Housing, Communities & Local Government

Rough Sleeping Data Framework Dashboard

Date: March 2025

Area: All

About the data

Since May 2023, the Ministry of Housing, Communities and Local Government has been collecting data on metrics as part of a framework to better understand how far
wherever possible, and where it does occur, whether it is **rare**, **brief**, and **non-recurring**.

Making rough sleeping rare

People estimated to be sleeping rough, those who have been accommodated

7,718
people sleeping rough this month
▲ 5% since last year

13.4
rate per 100,000 people

1,197
people had moved into accommodation by the end of the month
▼ -5% since last month

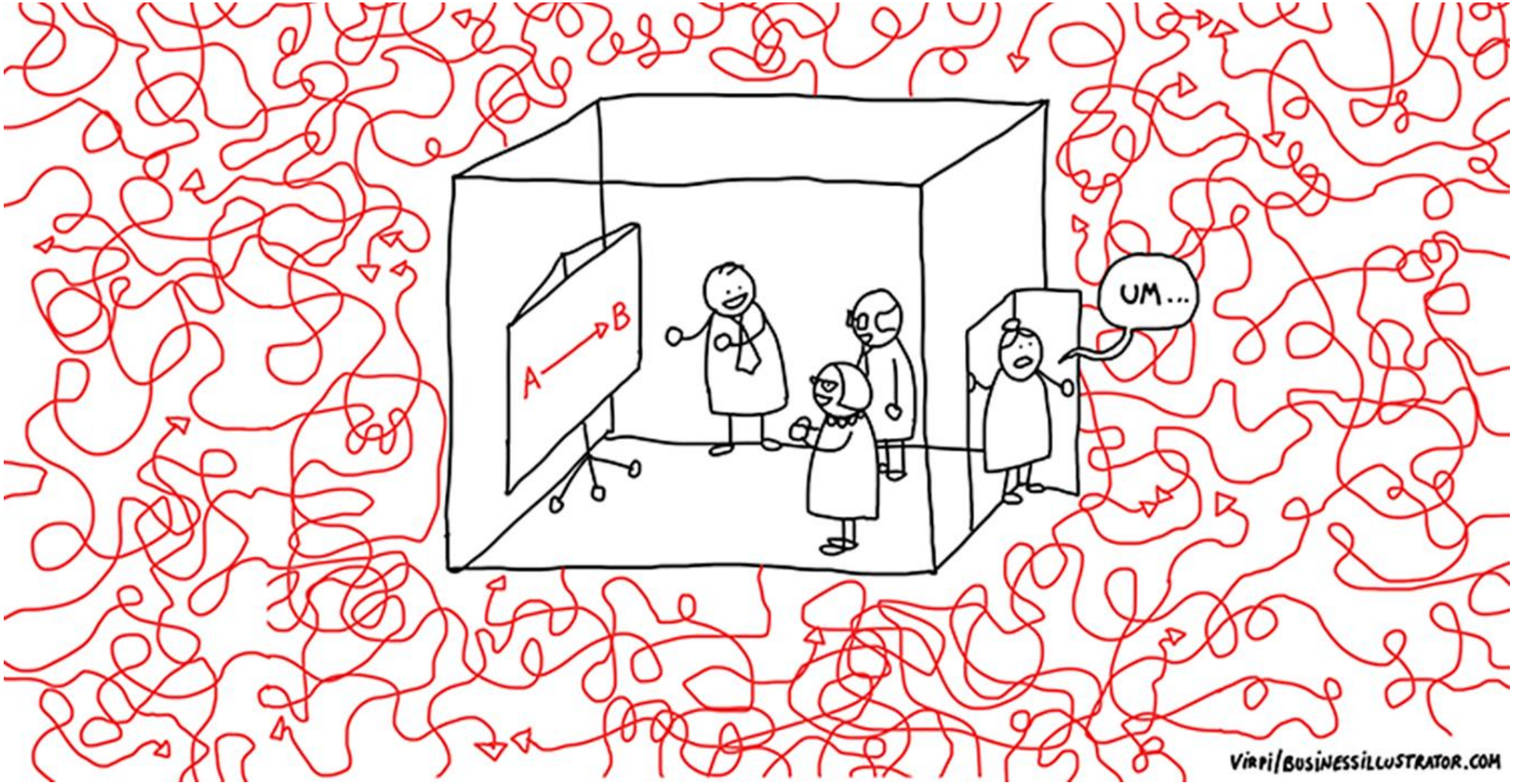
16%
of monthly rough sleepers had moved into accommodation by the end of the month

3,438
people sleeping rough on a single night
▲ 11% since last year

6.0
rate per 100,000 people

“We have to stay within the scope of funding - creative thinking is not applicable anymore it has to be hard facts only.”




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“I am hopeful the publicity homelessness is getting may help, I just worry planners and policy makers don't think enough about the overall wrap around approach to the problem.”

